Kabuor ERP: System Documentation

Technologies, Costs, Development Timeline, Challenges, and Use Across User Profiles and Industries

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Author Note

This document describes Kabuor ERP as built in the repository *vitamind38/kabuor-erp* at commit 05712f7, together with the companion Kabuor Builds shop platform. Figures marked as estimates are the author's own and are labelled as such. Correspondence concerning this document should be addressed to Kabuor Builds, Nairobi, Kenya.

Abstract

Kabuor ERP is a cloud enterprise resource planning (ERP) system built for small and medium-sized businesses in Kenya. It brings sales, point of sale, M-Pesa payments, stock, purchasing, production, payroll, customer relationship management, marketing, accounting, and Kenya Revenue Authority (KRA) electronic tax invoicing (eTIMS) into one application, with an assistant and supervised artificial intelligence (AI) agents that propose work for people to approve. This document records the technologies used and why, the cost of building and running the system, the development timeline, the challenges met and how each was resolved, how the system works internally, and how it serves each user profile and the main industries it targets. The system was built between October 16 and 21, 2026 by a single developer working with an AI coding assistant; at the time of writing it has 102 automated tests, a continuous-integration pipeline on SQLite and PostgreSQL, and a month-long simulated operation of a Nairobi distributor whose books reconciled on every check. Its main limitations are that external integrations (eTIMS, Safaricom, SMS, AI) have been tested only against stand-ins and sandboxes, that it has not been load-tested on its production database, and that it has no paying customers yet.

Keywords: enterprise resource planning, small and medium enterprises, Kenya, eTIMS, M-Pesa, payroll, AI agents

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Introduction

Small and medium-sized businesses in Kenya run their finances on a combination of tools that rarely talk to each other: a point-of-sale till, an M-Pesa statement read by hand, a spreadsheet for stock, an accountant's package for the books, and a separate payroll service. Since the Finance Act (2023), an expense can only be deducted for tax if it is backed by an electronic tax invoice, and since January 2026 KRA has compared declared income and expenses with eTIMS invoice data (KPMG, 2026). A business therefore needs every sale and purchase to pass through eTIMS, while most of its customers pay through M-Pesa.

Kabuor ERP was built to remove that fragmentation. It is one application, priced in shillings, in which a sale is invoiced, signed with KRA, matched to the M-Pesa payment that settles it, taken out of stock, and posted to the books in a single step. This document is a reference for owners, staff, accountants, implementers, investors, and developers. It describes what was built, with what, at what cost, in how long, against which difficulties, and how each kind of user and business uses it.

Scope of This Document

The document covers the Kabuor ERP application (the application programming interface, the web application, the database, and the background services) and, where it touches the ERP, the Kabuor Builds shop platform, which runs online shops and the company website. It does not cover regulatory registration (for example, with the Office of the Data Protection Commissioner) or legal review, which are outside the technical build.

System Overview

The system is organised into modules that share one set of books and one customer, product, and employee record. Table 1 lists them.

Table 1

Modules of Kabuor ERP and What Each Does

Module	What it does
Sales	Quotes and invoices with VAT-inclusive prices, customer price lists, units such as crates and cartons, credit limits, and voiding with a KRA credit note.
Point of sale (till)	A till with opening float and closing count, barcode search, cash, M-Pesa and card payments, offline selling with later synchronisation, and 58 mm or 80 mm thermal receipts.
Money in (M-Pesa)	Paybill and till payments received from Safaricom and matched to invoices automatically; payment prompts (STK push) sent from an invoice; statement import and reconciliation.
Stock	Several stores, moving-average cost, counts, transfers, reorder levels, batches with expiry dates sold first-to-expire-first-out, and write-offs.
Purchasing	Suppliers, purchase orders, bills, supplier payments, and supplier invoices received from KRA eTIMS.
Production	Recipes, capacity from stock on hand, and production runs that consume ingredients and produce finished goods.
People and payroll	Employees, leave, statutory payroll (PAYE, NSSF, SHIF, Housing Levy, NITA), deductions such as HELB and SACCO loans that apply only once the employee agrees, payslips, and a self-service portal.
Customers and marketing	Leads, pipeline, follow-ups, segments, SMS and WhatsApp campaigns with opt-outs.
Accounting and reports	Double-entry ledger, profit and loss, balance sheet, cash flow, trial balance, VAT return with withheld VAT, iTax CSV export, and ageing.
Assistant and agents	Msaidizi, an assistant that answers in English, Kiswahili, or Sheng; and agents that draft reminders, match payments, reorder stock, read supplier invoices and customer orders, plus agents the owner describes.
Platform	Subscription plans in shillings with a 30-day trial, data import from Excel, QuickBooks, or Sage, a public API with signed webhooks, and privacy and terms pages.

Technologies Used

The technologies were chosen for three reasons: the work is mostly money and rules, which favour a strongly typed language and a relational database; the users are often on phones with patchy connections, which favours a light web application that can work offline; and the system is run by a very small team, which favours managed hosting and a single deployable unit. Table 2 lists each technology and its role.

Table 2

Technologies, Versions, and Their Roles

Layer	Technology (version)	Role and reason
Server language	C# on .NET 10	Typed, fast, and well supported for financial rules; one runtime for the API and background services (Microsoft, n.d.-a).
Web framework	ASP.NET Core minimal APIs	Small endpoint definitions with built-in authentication, rate limiting, and dependency injection.
Data access	Entity Framework Core 10	Object mapping, migrations, per-company query filters, and optimistic concurrency (Microsoft, n.d.-b).
Production database	PostgreSQL 18 (Railway)	Reliable relational store with transactions for double-entry accounting (PostgreSQL Global Development Group, n.d.).
Local database	SQLite	Zero-setup development and fast automated tests.
Authentication	JSON Web Tokens; TOTP	Stateless sign-in, token versions to end sessions, optional two-step sign-in, AES-GCM sealing of stored secrets.
Web application	React 19, TypeScript, React Router 8	Component-based interface with type checking (Meta Open Source, n.d.).
Styling and build	Tailwind CSS 4, Vite 8	Consistent design tokens and fast builds; the build is served by the API.
Icons and QR	Lucide, qrcode	Interface icons; QR codes on eTIMS-signed receipts.
Offline	Service worker; local storage queue	The till loads and sells without internet and synchronises later.
Tax authority	KRA eTIMS OSCU API	Item registration, invoice signing, credit notes, and supplier invoices (Kenya Revenue Authority [KRA], n.d.).
Payments	Safaricom Daraja (C2B, STK push)	Receiving paybill and till payments; sending payment prompts (Safaricom PLC, n.d.).
Messaging	Africa’s Talking SMS; WhatsApp links	Reminders and campaigns.
Artificial intelligence	Anthropic Claude API	The assistant, agent reasoning, and reading customer orders (Anthropic, 2026).
Error monitoring	Sentry (server and browser)	Crash and error reports without personal data (Functional Software, n.d.).
Hosting	Docker on Railway; Vercel	The ERP runs as one container on Railway; the company website runs on Vercel (Railway Corp., n.d.; Vercel Inc., n.d.).
Source and automation	GitHub; GitHub Actions	Private repository, tests on every push against SQLite and PostgreSQL, nightly encrypted backups.
Testing	xUnit 2.9; ASP.NET test host	102 tests that drive the real API end to end, plus a month-long simulation script.

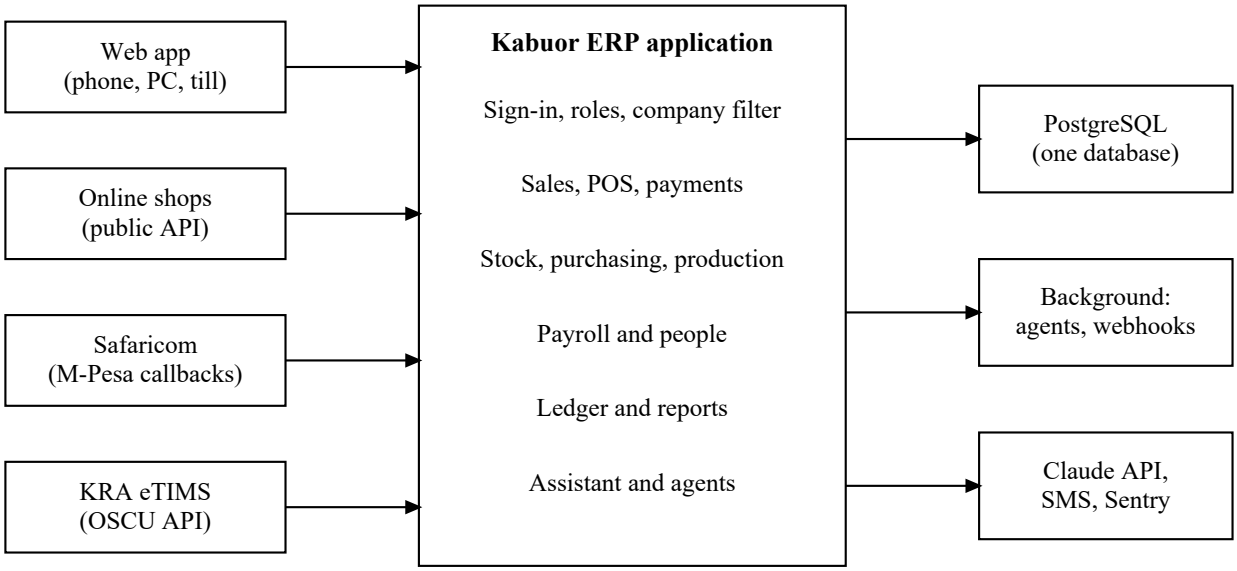
Layer	Technology (version)	Role and reason
Shop platform	Node.js, Express 5, node:sqlite, React 19	Multi-shop online stores with one database per shop; sends paid orders to the ERP.
Development tools	Claude Code; Visual Studio Code	AI-assisted development by one developer.

Architecture

Figure 1 shows how the parts fit together. Every person, till, and outside service talks to one ASP.NET Core application. The application decides which company a request belongs to from the sign-in token or the secret key in a callback address, and every database query is filtered by that company, so one business can never see another's records. Business rules live in service classes (sales, payments, stock, payroll, eTIMS, agents) which always post to the double-entry ledger in the same database transaction as the business change.

Figure 1

Architecture of Kabuor ERP



Every change and its ledger entries are saved in one transaction.

How the System Works

Selling and Getting Paid

When a salesperson issues an invoice, the system, in one database transaction, (a) checks the customer's credit limit, (b) posts the sale and its VAT to the ledger, (c) takes the goods out of stock at their moving-average cost, drawing first from the batch that expires

soonest and refusing expired stock, and (d) queues the invoice for signing with KRA. Signing returns a receipt number, a control code, and a QR code that are printed on the invoice. If KRA cannot be reached, the sale still stands and signing is retried.

When a customer pays the business's M-Pesa paybill, Safaricom sends a confirmation to a secret address unique to that business. The system records the payment once, even if Safaricom sends the same confirmation again, and matches it to an invoice: with certainty when the account number is the invoice or customer number, as a strong likelihood when it comes from the customer's own phone, and only as a guess when nothing but the amount agrees. Certain matches are applied immediately; the rest go to a person or, within an owner-set limit, to the payment matching agent. From an invoice, staff can also send an M-Pesa prompt to the customer's phone, and the payment lands on that invoice when Safaricom confirms it.

The Till and Offline Selling

A cashier opens the till with a float, sells by tapping products or scanning barcodes, and closes the till by counting the drawer. If the internet drops, the till keeps working from the last price list saved on the device; each sale is given a unique key on the device and queued. When the connection returns, the queue is sent; a sale that arrives twice is recorded once and keeps the time it was really made. Receipts print at 58 mm, 80 mm, or A4.

Buying, Stock, and Production

Purchase orders go to suppliers; when goods arrive the order becomes a bill, and posting the bill adds the stock at its cost and records what is owed. Items kept by batch need the batch number and expiry when the bill is posted. Supplier invoices issued through eTIMS can be fetched from KRA and accepted as bills. For manufacturers, a recipe lists ingredients per batch; a production run consumes them and adds the finished product at the combined cost.

Payroll

Each month, HR starts a payroll run. The system calculates gross pay, NSSF, the Social Health Insurance Fund (SHIF) contribution, the Affordable Housing Levy, PAYE after personal and pension relief, and agreed deductions such as HELB repayments, SACCO loans,

and salary advances. A deduction applies only after the employee agrees in the portal, or after HR records a signed form or a HELB notice, and the system never deducts so much that the employee keeps less than one third of wages, as section 19(3) of the Employment Act (2007) requires. The accountant approves the run, which posts salaries and every amount owed to KRA, NSSF, SHIF, the Housing Levy, and third parties.

Books and Reports

Every business event posts balanced entries to a chart of accounts. From the ledger the system produces the profit and loss statement, balance sheet, cash flow, trial balance, VAT return (with VAT withheld by customers), iTax import files, and customer and supplier ageing. Bank and M-Pesa statements can be imported and matched to the books.

Agents and the Assistant

The design of the agents follows what Microsoft, SAP, Oracle, and Odoo ship in their ERPs (Microsoft, n.d.-c; Odoo S.A., n.d.; Oracle, n.d.; SAP SE, n.d.). An agent acts under its own name and only with the rights of the person who switched it on. It starts on a schedule, when a business event wakes it (for example, a payment that could not be matched), or when a person hands it work. It drafts; a person approves anything that leaves the business or moves money, unless the owner allows it to act alone when it is sure and the amount is within a limit. Table 3 lists the agents.

Table 3

Agents in Kabuor ERP

Agent	Does by itself	Asks first
Collections	Finds overdue invoices; drafts reminders in English or Kiswahili.	Sending any message (later reminders to customers already approved can go automatically by SMS, if the owner allows).
Payment matching	Applies certain matches; works out the likely invoice for others.	Applying uncertain matches (likely matches within the limit may be applied, if allowed).
Restock	Watches reorder levels; drafts purchase orders to the last supplier.	Sending an order (regular suppliers within the limit, if allowed).
Payables	Reads supplier invoices from KRA; finds the purchase order; notes differences.	Recording the bill (exact matches within the limit, if allowed).
Order taking	Reads a pasted WhatsApp, SMS, or email order; drafts a quote at the customer's prices; names what it could not match.	Sending the quote.
Owner-built agents	Whatever the owner describes, using only the skills ticked.	Everything it proposes.

How It Works for Each User Profile

Each person signs in with a role. The role decides which menus, pages, and actions they see, and the server enforces the same rules on every request. Table 4 summarises what each role can do; the subsections describe a typical day.

Table 4

Roles and What Each Can Do

Role	Can see	Can do
Owner	Everything	Everything, including users, settings, plan and billing, agents, credit limits, and approvals.
Accountant	Sales, money, purchases, stock, payroll, reports	Post bills, pay suppliers, match payments, approve payroll, set credit terms, run VAT and iTax reports. No till.
Sales	Customers, quotes, invoices, money in, CRM	Sell at the till, make quotes and invoices, record payments, hand orders to the order taking agent.
Storekeeper	Stock, purchases, production	Count and transfer stock, raise purchase orders, receive goods, run production.
Procurement	Suppliers, purchases, stock	Raise purchase orders and receive goods.
HR	Employees, leave, payroll	Add employees and deductions, approve leave, start payroll runs, give employees portal access.
Viewer	Reports, sales, stock (read only)	Look only; suited to an investor, auditor, or partner.
Employee	Their own portal	Apply for leave, download payslips and the P9 form, agree to or decline deductions.

Owner.

The owner opens *Today*, which shows money in this week, overdue invoices, payments waiting to be matched, cash in M-Pesa and the bank, and VAT owed. They approve what the agents have drafted, ask Msaidizi questions such as “Nani ananidai zaidi?” (“Who owes me the most?”), and set the rules: credit limits, price lists, how much each agent may decide alone, and whether stock may be sold below zero.

Accountant.

The accountant enters and posts supplier bills, imports the month’s M-Pesa and bank statements to reconcile them, records VAT withheld by customers, approves payroll, and at month end downloads the VAT return figures and iTax files and reviews the balance sheet and trial balance.

Salesperson and cashier.

The cashier opens the till, sells, and closes with a count. A salesperson makes quotes and invoices, sends M-Pesa prompts from invoices, pastes customer orders for the order taking agent, and follows up leads. They cannot change credit terms or prices on price lists.

Storekeeper and procurement officer.

They watch low stock and expiring batches, raise and receive purchase orders, count stock, transfer between stores, write off expired batches, and run production.

HR officer.

HR adds employees with their statutory numbers, records leave, sets up deductions that wait for the employee's agreement, starts the monthly payroll run, and gives employees access to the self-service portal by phone number.

Employee.

An employee signs in with their phone number, chooses their own password, applies for leave, downloads payslips and the P9 tax form, and agrees to or declines deductions such as a HELB repayment.

Developers and integrators.

An outside system uses an API key made in Settings to read products and send orders (each order is recorded once however many times it is sent), and receives signed webhook messages when payments arrive or invoices are paid.

How It Works Across Industries

The same application adapts to different kinds of business through settings rather than separate versions. Table 5 shows how the main industries in the target market use it, and where it is less suited.

Table 5

Use of Kabuor ERP by Industry

Industry	Features that matter most	Fit
Retail shops and minimarts	Till with barcode and offline selling, M-Pesa matching, thermal receipts, reorder levels, restock agent.	Strong
Wholesale and distribution	Customer price lists, crates and cartons, credit limits, statements, collections agent, order taking agent for WhatsApp orders.	Strong
Food and beverage manufacturing	Recipes, production runs, batch costing, batches with expiry, eTIMS with reduced and exempt VAT bands.	Strong
Pharmacies and agro-vets	Batches and expiry sold first-to-expire-first-out, expired stock blocked and written off, supplier invoices from eTIMS.	Good; no prescription records
Restaurants and cafes	Till, recipes for ingredient costing, daily takings, M-Pesa.	Good; no table or kitchen screens
Professional services	Service items, quotes, invoices, withholding VAT and tax certificates, collections, CRM.	Good
Online sellers	Kabuor Builds shops that send paid orders to the ERP, public API, M-Pesa prompts.	Strong
Hardware and construction supply	Units (bags, pieces), price lists, credit limits, several stores.	Good; no project costing
Schools, NGOs, and churches	Invoicing and payroll work, but there is no fund or grant accounting or student billing.	Limited

Development Timeline

The system was built by one developer with an AI coding assistant over six days. The shop platform came first (October 16–20, 2026); the ERP was built on October 20 and extended on October 21. Table 6 lists the main steps from the source history.

Table 6

Development Timeline

Date (2026)	Work completed
October 16	Kabuor Builds shop platform: self-service, multi-shop online stores; brand kit.
October 18–19	Shop platform hosted on Vercel; owner dashboard, M-Pesa prompts per shop, backups.
October 20, morning	Kabuor ERP first version: sales, eTIMS-ready invoices, M-Pesa matching, books and VAT, buying and stock, till, payroll, CRM, production, marketing, employee portal, assistant, and first three agents.
October 20, evening	Production readiness: database migrations, two-step sign-in, sessions, continuous integration, nightly encrypted backups; deployed on Railway.
October 21, morning	Kenyan market gaps: real eTIMS integration, accountant reports, M-Pesa prompts and statements, offline till, plans and trial, import, price lists, units, batches, credit limits, public API, webhooks, legal pages, consent-based deductions; agents extended with review policies, event triggers, payables and order taking agents, and the agent studio.
October 21, late morning	Month-long simulation of a Nairobi distributor; five defects found and fixed; error monitoring added.

In conventional terms, the author estimates the scope at six to nine developer-months for a small team without AI assistance; the AI assistant compressed this to days, but the work still required the developer to set direction, review results, and decide every trade-off.

Cost

Cost of Building

The direct cash cost of building was the developer's own tool subscriptions (the AI coding assistant and existing hardware and internet), which are not itemised here. Table 7 gives the author's estimate of what the same scope would cost to build conventionally, as a reference for valuation and budgeting.

Table 7

Estimated Cost of Building the Same Scope Conventionally

Approach	Effort	Estimated cost (KSh)
In-house team at local senior salaries (about KSh 250,000–400,000 per developer-month)	6–9 developer-months	2,000,000–4,000,000
Kenyan software agency	Same scope, quoted	4,000,000–8,000,000
Customised open-source ERP (for comparison)	Implementation of ERPNext or Odoo with eTIMS, M-Pesa, and payroll	300,000–910,000 plus monthly support

Note. Estimates by the author. Comparison figures for customised open-source ERP are from IT Kenya (2026) and Aqiq Solutions (2026).

Cost of Running

Table 8 lists the services the system uses and how they are charged. Most have free tiers sufficient for a pilot.

Table 8

Running Costs

Service	Purpose	How it is charged
Railway	Hosting the ERP and its PostgreSQL database	Paid plan with usage-based charges (Railway Corp., n.d.).
Vercel	Company website	Free hobby tier.
GitHub and GitHub Actions	Source code, tests, nightly backups	Free tier for a private repository.
Anthropic Claude API	Assistant, agents, order reading	Per use (tokens); the largest variable cost as businesses grow.
Africa's Talking	SMS reminders and campaigns	Per message.
Safaricom Daraja	M-Pesa callbacks and prompts	No API fee; normal M-Pesa tariffs are paid by the business.
KRA eTIMS	Tax invoice signing	No fee.
Sentry	Error alerts and uptime	Free developer tier.

Price to Customers

Plans are set in shillings per business, with a 30-day free trial. The launch configuration is KSh 1,500 (Starter), KSh 4,500 (Business), and KSh 9,500 (Growth) per month, with a year charged as ten months; prices are a server setting and can change without a release. For comparison, Zoho Books in Kenya lists KSh 999 to 18,000 per month for

accounting only (FNJ Associates, 2026), Veira lists KSh 2,999 to 9,999 for accounting and point of sale (Veira, 2026), and Odoo costs about KSh 1,155 per user per month before implementation (Aqiq Solutions, 2026). The author recommends raising the launch prices to about KSh 2,500, 6,500, and 12,500–15,000 and metering AI use beyond a monthly allowance.

Challenges Met and How They Were Resolved

Table 9 records the significant problems met during the build, in order, and how each was resolved. Several were found only by the month-long simulation described in the next section, which is why it was run.

Table 9

Challenges and Resolutions

Challenge	Resolution
A live database created before migrations existed had to be brought under migration control without data loss.	On start, the system detects such a database, records it as being at the first migration, and applies only later ones.
Railway stopped deploying new versions during a platform outage, and later lost access to the private GitHub repository.	The service source was reconnected; repository access must be re-granted by the account owner. Deployment waits for tests to pass.
The nightly backup could not reach the database through Railway's internal address.	A public TCP proxy was added and the backup script was made to show exactly what is wrong with a supplied address without revealing it.
The company website failed to build on Vercel because its root directory was the client folder.	The Vercel configuration was moved into the client folder and the build installs from the workspace root.
SQLite cannot compare or sort some date-time values that PostgreSQL can.	Those comparisons are done in memory after narrowing the query, so the same code runs on both.
Two document numbers taken in one save conflicted.	Number sequences check the records already being saved before reading the database.
On existing SQLite databases, a new index was created before its new column existed, crashing start-up.	Schema updates now create tables, then add missing columns, then create indexes.
An agent's spending limit stored as a whole number could not be read back as a long number.	Agent settings are read through a tolerant number parser.
Backdated invoices were refused because batch expiry was judged against today.	Expiry is judged on the sale date.
Stock value disagreed with the ledger by about 6%.	Items sold below zero had been counted as zero; stock value is now signed and agrees with the ledger to the shilling, and owners can forbid selling below zero.

Challenge	Resolution
Purchase orders for batch-kept products demanded batch numbers, which crashed the restock agent.	Batch numbers are required only when a bill is posted.
The till offered products whose only remaining stock had expired.	The till counts only sellable stock.
The development editor kept the build output locked while it ran its own copy of the server.	Builds and tests write to separate output folders; demonstrations run on another port.

Quality Assurance

Quality is checked in three ways. First, 102 automated tests drive the real application programming interface through a test host, from registration to month-end reports, including role restrictions, company isolation, payroll rules, eTIMS behaviour against a simulated KRA, M-Pesa prompts against a simulated Safaricom, agents against a simulated AI, webhooks, and the public API. Second, every push to the repository runs the tests twice, on SQLite and on PostgreSQL with the real migrations. Third, a simulation script plays a month of trading at a fictional Nairobi distributor through the live interface: six staff accounts, eight employees, twenty products (five kept by batch), twenty customers on credit, about 140 invoices, about 70 M-Pesa payments with deliberate duplicates, a busy till hour, online orders, offline sales, payroll, agents, and statement reconciliation. Table 10 shows the checks made at the end of the simulated month.

Table 10

Results of the Month-End Checks in the Final Simulation Run

Check	Result
Trial balance balances	Passed
Balance sheet balances (assets equal liabilities plus equity)	Passed
Receivables account equals what customers owe	Passed, to the shilling
Stock account equals stock on hand at cost	Passed, to the shilling
VAT report equals VAT on the month's invoices	Passed
Each M-Pesa receipt recorded once despite repeated confirmations	Passed
Offline sale sent twice kept once	Passed
Online order sent twice kept once	Passed
Employee keeps at least one third of pay despite a large advance	Passed
Salesperson cannot change credit terms	Passed
No server errors	Passed; median response 12 ms, 95th percentile 73 ms

Note. The simulation ran on SQLite on a developer computer; it has not yet been repeated on PostgreSQL under concurrent load.

Security and Privacy

- Every query is limited to the signed-in person's company; callbacks from Safaricom and KRA are tied to a company by a secret key in their address.
- Roles are enforced on the server, not only hidden in the interface; approving an agent's proposal needs the approver's own rights.
- Passwords are hashed; sign-in locks after five wrong attempts; two-step sign-in and "sign out everywhere" are available.
- Stored secrets such as KRA and Daraja keys are encrypted; API keys are stored only as hashes and shown once.
- The web application runs under a strict content security policy; error reports to Sentry exclude names, phone numbers, and request bodies.
- The privacy notice and terms are written for the Data Protection Act (2019) and the Tax Procedures Act (2015), and await legal review.

Limitations and Future Work

- The eTIMS, M-Pesa, SMS, and AI integrations have been tested against stand-ins; sandbox and live certification remain.
- The system has not been load-tested on PostgreSQL; when two sales collide, one may fail instead of retrying automatically.
- Some screens and agents read whole tables into memory, which will slow down after years of busy trading.
- Background agents and webhooks assume a single server instance.
- There is no accounting period lock, partial credit note, customer return, fixed asset register, or multi-currency support.
- The web application has no automated interface tests.
- The WhatsApp Business API is not integrated; WhatsApp is used through prepared message links.
- There are no paying customers yet; a pilot with three to five businesses is the next step.

Conclusion

Kabuor ERP shows that a single developer working with an AI assistant can, in under a week, build an ERP whose scope matches products that normally take teams many months, and whose books reconcile under a realistic month of trading. Its distinguishing features for the Kenyan market are native eTIMS, deep M-Pesa handling, statutory payroll with consent-based deductions, offline selling, and supervised AI agents, at a price in shillings per business. Its next milestones are technical certification of its integrations, load testing on its production database, and real use by paying businesses.

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